

It is time to run the exploit. This will start a web server on our attack system. This will also generate a Python command that we will use to connect to the newly created web server. Before all that, we need to set the target (0 in this case), selecting the Python exploit.

- `msf > set target 0`

We can type exploit now

- `msf > exploit`

The last thing this exploit will write is “Run the following command on the target machine”. This is followed by the command we need to execute on the victim’s system. So, copy this code for further use.

Take the command copied to the victim’s system. We’re using an Ubuntu 20.04 system and will have to use the sudo command to gain root access. Once this script has been run on the victim’s system, you will be able to see that a Meterpreter has been started on the target system! We commandeer that box now! The Meterpreter runs in the background. We can bring it forward

- `msf > sessions -l`

This will generate a list of active sessions that can be used to access those sessions. The session ID, in this case, is 1. So, we can access it by

- `msf > sessions -i 1`

This will bring the Meterpreter session to the front, and the meterpreter prompt can be seen. We can control the system by running Meterpreter commands/scripts. Most scripts are written especially for Windows systems.

Why run attacks?

- A hacker can ruin the reputation of a well-established organization by editing their website content to include explicit content. The fact that an organization couldn’t protect its servers is a shame in itself.
- The web server can install malicious software on users who visit the website. This can be used to spread viruses and compromise other computers. Trojan or Botnet Software spread in this fashion. Greater the traffic, the greater the damage.
- Any user might file lawsuits against the organization supposed to protect their data. The fact that other users will migrate will lead to plummeting share prices and business loss.
- Another reason would be to make money by bagging bug bounty rewards